

Bessent rolls out financial ‘D-Day’ for Iran

The U.S. unveils plan for all-out economic attack on Tehran and its trade partners.

By Ana Ceballos and Nabih Bulos

WASHINGTON — The United States unveiled plans Monday for new sanctions against Iran that Trump administration officials said are designed to sever Tehran from the global financial system as the nearly six-month conflict between the two countries drags on.

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, who previewed the announcement last week as “economic D-Day,” described the measures as the opening of an all-out financial assault on the Iranian government and its trade partners — a group that includes China, India, Turkey and the United Arab Emirates.

“To those who enable Tehran, do not discount the cost of testing Washington’s resolve,” Bessent said at a news conference. “No nation should expect to enjoy the rewards of our system while helping those who seek to destroy it.”

Bessent said it was time for world leaders to “make a decision” between “America and Iran,” adding that President Trump has already been calling foreign leaders to make specific requests ahead of the new sanctions.

But when asked whom the president had been talking to, Bessent said he would not “name names.” He also said the secondary measure would not take effect immediately, arguing that the administration is trying to give “everyone the opportunity to remedy bad behavior.”

“Why would I want to blow up the global financial system?” Bessent said when a reporter pressed him on why the sanctions weren’t immediate. “We believe that it is important to level set and give people a cure period, but they should know [See Iran, A7]



CARLIN STIEHL For The Times



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

PEOPLE cool off at a misting station at the Just Like Heaven festival at the Rose Bowl, top. Above, fans use fans to beat the heat at Dodger Stadium.

The heat is rising, and so is the misery index

SoCal summer of hotter nights, broiling beaches

By Alex Wigglesworth and Karen Garcia

On paper, Southern California’s summer heat has been “pretty typical,” in the words of Mike Wofford, meteorologist with the National Weather Service in Oxnard.

So why do so many people swear this summer has felt so unusually oppressive? Experts point to several factors to explain the summer discomfort. Nighttime temperatures remain stubbornly high. And it’s been broiling along the coast, which typically offers a cooler respite from the heat.

“It’s been an extraordinarily, arguably record-breakingly, warm summer at night,” said climate scientist Daniel Swain, “but not so much in terms of the hottest daytime temperatures, which is what everybody always talks about in terms of how hot it’s been.”

Don’t expect any relief this week.

Southern California is staring down its hottest week of the year yet, with temperatures expected to rival daily records

in downtown Los Angeles, Long Beach, Santa Monica and Burbank, according to the National Weather Service.

The latest heat wave continues what’s proving to be a sweltering summer globally as temperatures rise because of climate change, with last month tying 2024 as the warmest July since record-keeping began in 1850, per the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration.

Experts said they are not surprised the hot conditions are taking a toll.

Hotter nights can prolong the stress that heat places on the human body by depriving people of a chance to recover, increasing the risk of heat-related illness. Such conditions also put more strain on animals, plants and infrastructure.

Many parts of the U.S. are seeing overnight temperatures warming faster than daytime maximum temperatures, which appears to have become a hallmark of climate change in some regions, said Swain, an [See Heat, A6]



RONALDO BOLAÑOS Los Angeles Times

CANALS that carry water to Phoenix could also be cut off under the Trump administration’s plan.

Nevada sues U.S. over plan for water

More legal action is likely over proposed cuts due to Colorado River shortages.

By Ian James

In the first salvo of what could become a prolonged court battle over Colorado River water, the state of Nevada has sued the Trump administration over its plan to impose major water cut-backs on Las Vegas.

The state filed the lawsuit three days after the Trump administration re-

leased the plan requiring Nevada, Arizona and California to cut water use by about 20% for the next two years. The plan allows for much larger mandatory cuts over the next decade if necessary to prevent the river’s drought-depleted reservoirs from reaching critically low levels.

“Southern Nevada could lose more than 70% of its already meager Colorado River allocation,” while four other states — Colorado, Utah, New Mexico and Wyoming — “are not required to contribute a drop,” Nevada Gov. Joe Lombardo, a Re-

[See Nevada, A7]

Court is skeptical of Bianco ballot seizure

State justices question his authority to take 600,000 ballots after the Prop. 50 election.

By Sonja Sharp

California Supreme Court justices hammered Riverside County Sheriff Chad Bianco over his seizure of more than 600,000 Proposition 50 ballots in a pair of back-to-back hearings on Monday, appearing poised to order the ballots returned and sharply limit the sheriff’s power to snatch similar election materials in the future.

Bianco, a Republican who came in fourth in this spring’s crowded California gubernatorial primary, carted off truckloads of ballots from the Riverside County Registrar of Voters in February, after securing a warrant based on claims that the office allowed fraudulent votes in the special election to redraw California’s congressional districts last fall.

According to a sworn declaration by one of Bianco’s sergeants, armed deputies from Riverside County’s Special Investigations Bureau, Emergency

Response Team and SWAT unit were sent to sweep up pallets of sealed votes and bring them to the Moreno Valley Sheriff’s Station on Feb. 26 — a day after California Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta and Secretary of State Shirley Weber ordered Bianco to stand down.

In the days that followed, deputies began their own ad hoc recount — an activity they’d never been trained for, and which state officials and civil liberties groups say flies in the face of the plain language of the state’s election law that says “in no event shall ballots be moved.”

Voters sued. So did Bonta. In oral arguments on both cases Monday morning, California’s seven Supreme Court justices appeared at times flabbergasted by claims that the move was not only permitted but blessed under state law — and that California’s top cop had no power to block it.

“I’m just wondering ... why didn’t the sheriff’s office contemplate the available routes under the elections code for resolving the alleged disparity?” asked Associate Justice Goodwin H. Liu. “Isn’t there a procedure for resolving this?” [See Bianco, A6]

Trump allowed to plan for new mail ballot rules

But Supreme Court doesn’t permit changes to be adopted yet. Bonta vows to sue.

By David G. Savage and Kevin Rector

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court cleared the way Monday for President Trump to continue seeking new limits on the use of mail ballots, though their implementation remains in dispute as the November election rapidly approaches.

California leaders immediately noted the limits of the high court ruling and said they would file a lawsuit to prevent Trump’s desired changes from taking effect.

“The Supreme Court just let the Trump administration move ahead (for now) with its plan to disenfranchise voters across the country. California will be suing AGAIN to block these Orwellian rules from being implemented,” Gov. Gavin Newsom said in a statement.

Acting by a 6-3 vote, the court’s conservatives granted an emergency appeal from Trump’s lawyers and set aside a lower judge’s order that blocked federal

agencies — including the Department of Homeland Security and the U.S. Postal Service — from advancing new federal regulations on states and their use of mail ballots.

Trump called for those regulations in a March executive order directing Homeland Security to compile its own lists of eligible citizen voters in each state and the postal service to restrict its processing of mail ballots to those submitted by individuals on those Homeland Security lists.

The high court’s ruling allows those agencies to move forward with their work to comply with Trump’s order but reaches no conclusions as to the legality of those pending rules.

“The Court’s disposition of this application does not mean that any measure taken by the Government to implement the Order will necessarily be lawful. On that score, time will tell,” the high court wrote.

The unsigned order spoke for the six Republican appointees. The three liberals, all Democratic appointees, dissented in two separate opinions.

California officials stressed that the court’s ruling [See Voting rules, A6]

Bonta pulls out of Paramount talks

He says firm leaked information ahead of mediation to resolve Warner merger suit.

By Meg James

California Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta abruptly pulled out of a planned mediation session Monday to seek a resolution to the antitrust lawsuit that has stalled Paramount Skydance’s blockbuster \$13-billion merger with Warner Bros. Discovery.

Bonta, in a statement, accused Paramount of leaking and misrepresenting information the two sides had discussed during a preliminary session Friday. He said Paramount was “playing games.”

Representatives of Bonta and Paramount Skydance came together late last week to set ground rules for Monday’s meeting, which was to involve Paramount Skydance Chief Executive David Ellison.

One of the rules had been confidentiality of the media-

tion process. But, over the weekend, a stream of news stories contained information about the proposed summit.

Late Sunday, the Wall Street Journal published deal points that it said Bonta was preparing to offer Paramount in exchange for dropping his lawsuit. Terms included asking the company to sell some basic cable TV channels because the merged entity would control more than 50, including CNN, Comedy Central, Cartoon Network, HGTV and MTV.

Bonta also was going to call for keeping the Warner Bros. film studio separate from Paramount Pictures — which would be a nonstarter for Ellison, who wants to create a Hollywood super-studio.

“Not only did Paramount leak the alleged substance of the settlement discussions, but they misrepresented these discussions, demonstrating a lack of good faith,” Bonta said Monday, noting: “I have pulled down this meeting.” [See Bonta, A10]



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

TRACKING A PARASITE

UC Riverside professor Adler Dillman first identified the liver fluke as the cause of an illness that baffled canine owners. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

A postproduction tax credit push

State lawmakers weigh legislation that is aimed at bringing those movie and TV jobs back to California. **BUSINESS, A9**

Weather

Sunny and hot. L.A. Basin: 94/73. **B6**

Markets

Opinion Voices

Turnover taking toll on Angel City

Soccer club tries to stop its coaching carousel, but fans are growing impatient. **SPORTS, B10**

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